

PostHog – Developer Marketer

I have been following PostHog for a couple of years. Product for Engineers is one of maybe three or four company newsletters I actually read end to end. Your company handbook is also wild. Someone like me can sit on the outside and see exactly how the company makes decisions internally. Most companies don't write any of that down, let alone publish it.

Back in February 2024, I went through your marketing post and the broader docs. The principle I kept coming back to was "build a channel you truly own." I started the Marketing In Action (MIA) newsletter in April 2024 partly because of it, and wrote a long article in June 2024 on customer acquisition channels that built directly on the same thinking (<https://newsletter.marketinginaction.xyz/p/mia-06-customer-acquisition-channels>). MIA is now at thousands of subscribers with a 47% open rate, written for marketers and founders inside SaaS and product-led companies. I tried other PostHog ideas at the same time: Pricing principles, Product intents, Growth review structure, and having a bias toward shipping the smallest useful change instead of trying to land everything at once. Some of these ideas stuck, some didn't. But the way of thinking shaped how I approach marketing inside engineer-led companies.

My background is marketing, but I have not stayed in one lane. I have spent time in product design, UX, customer research, lifecycle, GTM engineering, and sales. I was Chief Revenue Officer at one point. Most of my marketing roles have been as the first or only marketing hire, which means I had to be the entire function for a while before there was budget to grow a team. I figured out, partly by accident, that the only way to survive that was to build systems and write everything down. Positioning playbooks. Launch frameworks. Content workflows. Lifecycle flows. ICP definitions. Repeatable, first-principles stuff, applied to whatever surface needed work that week. The point was that the next person who joined didn't have to figure all of it out again from scratch.

That is also pretty much how PostHog already runs, from what I can tell. Public by default. PRs and RFCs over meetings. Small teams owning real outcomes, writing everything down, and driven with a bias for action. Joe's MVP marketing post this week made the marketing-side version of all this explicit, but reading the handbook, it has clearly been the engineering culture for years.

My recent work has gone deeper into AI tooling for marketing teams: agentic content workflows, MCP publishing pipelines, and 31+ open-source marketing agent skills on GitHub that other operators are running inside their own teams (<https://github.com/realjaymes>). All open-sourced because I believe the best knowledge should be shared.

James